MONTHLY UPDATE

Djibouti: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Regional collaboration

FINANCE
New investments

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity

DPI
Data Exchange

TECHNOLOGY
AI

CAPACITY
Training and skills

INCLUSION
Access to services

DATA
Use of satellite data

GEOPOLITICS
US / hyperscaler activities · China activities

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

CADRE D'INTEROPERABILITE DE DJIBOUTI

- **Djibouti – 2026 Government work programme: Omar Guelleh sets out his key priorities** — Africa24 TV, 6 September 2026

  Council of Ministers, 1 Sept 2026: paperless services and interoperability among the state-modernisation priorities.

Regional collaboration

DIGITAL COOPERATION ORGANIZATION MEMBERSHIP

- **Djibouti and DCO discuss cooperation on AI and digital transformation** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026

  DCO chief AlYahya and minister Gadileh discuss AI, skills and capacity building; no instrument or figure.

Finance

New investments

PRIVATE INVESTMENT PIPELINE IDENTIFIED BY DIAGNOSTIC

- **Djibouti Country Private Sector Diagnostic** — International Finance Corporation, 13 September 2026

  CPSD names data centres one of three sectors for private investment, with energy reform the priority.

- **World Bank Group Report Identifies Significant Private Investment Potential for Djibouti** — World Bank Group, 14 September 2026

  CPSD puts at least US$600m of private investment and about 12,000 jobs in reach over five years.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

HORIZON TERRESTRIAL FIBRE CORRIDOR

- **Projet de fibre optique « Horizon » : Une nouvelle autoroute numérique pour la Corne de l'Afrique** — La Nation, 9 September 2026 ETHIOPIA SUDAN

  Addis Ababa meeting pitches the Djibouti-Ethiopia-Sudan corridor to Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon and carriers.

DPI

Data Exchange

ELECTRONIC SINGLE WINDOW FOR TRADE

- **Djibouti Plans Electronic Single-window to Streamline Trade** — Dawan Africa, 2 September 2026

  Customs to build a single window with the AfCFTA Secretariat and Korea's CUPIA, beyond SYDONIAWORLD.

Technology

AI

FIRST NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY

- **Premier Forum national sur l'intelligence artificielle : Djibouti prend le virage de la révolution technologique** — La Nation (Djibouti), 2 September 2026

  Djibouti opened its first national forum on artificial intelligence at the Palais du Peuple on 2 and 3 September, organised by the ministry for the digital economy and innovation under the president's patronage. The framing is explicitly sovereignty: AI as a lever of independence, innovation and development rather than a technology to be received. The forum sits against Vision Djibouti 2035 and UNESCO's readiness assessment.

- **Somali must have a place in artificial intelligence, Djibouti minister tells first national forum** — Somali National News Agency (SONNA), 3 September 2026

  Somali, Afar and Arabic must be in the models or their speakers are out; 12 subsea cables landed, three more in progress.

- **Djibouti se dote d'une stratégie d'IA sur fond de préparation encore limitée** — wearetech.africa, 4 September 2026

Djibouti presented the main lines of its first national artificial-intelligence strategy, covering 2026 to 2030 around six priorities: data and AI governance, cybersecurity, training, research, innovation and inclusion. A UNESCO-supported readiness assessment presented alongside it classes the country as emerging, with an ICT development index of 61.6 against AI readiness of about 24.5 out of 100 and no legislation dedicated to artificial intelligence beyond the data-protection provisions of the digital code.

- **Intelligence artificielle : Djibouti lance sa premiere strategie nationale** — L'Observateur, 8 September 2026

  Six-axis AI strategy to 2030; UNESCO rates readiness 'emerging', ~24.5/100 against an ICT index of 61.6.

FIRST NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE FORUM

- **Intelligence artificielle : les acteurs d'un écosystème en construction** — La Nation, 3 September 2026

  HOOM used by 4,500 terminale pupils, about 57% of the year group; Bouho AI answers in Somali, Afar and Arabic.

- **Somali must have a place in artificial intelligence, Djibouti minister tells first national forum** — Somali National News Agency (SONNA), 3 September 2026

  Summarised under AI.

- **Premier Concours national de prototypage : Quand l'intelligence artificielle révèle les talents de la jeunesse djiboutienne** — La Nation, 7 September 2026

  First national AI prototyping competition, held at Djibouti's first national AI forum.

NATIONAL AI READINESS INDEX

- **Djibouti Telecom forme 35 ingénieurs à l'intelligence artificielle** — Agence Djiboutienne d'Information (ADI), 17 September 2026

  Djibouti's state operator certified 35 of its engineers in artificial intelligence at a ceremony presided over by the communications minister, who cited the national AI readiness assessment run on UNESCO's methodology: it credits engaged digital transformation, strategic infrastructure and a nascent academic base while finding room to improve on skills, governance and research. He called for closer ties between the operator, the university and research centres.

Capacity

Training and skills

TECHKID CODING AND ROBOTICS PROGRAMME

- **Clôture de TechKid 2026 : Une nouvelle génération de TechLeaders à Djibouti** — La Nation, 10 September 2026

  The first cohort of Djibouti's TechKid programme completed seven weeks of coding, robotics and artificial intelligence at the national technology and innovation centre. Ten children aged 9 to 16 presented their work to parents, mentors and trainers.

D-CLIC DIGITAL-SKILLS TRAINING PROGRAMME

- **Djibouti et l'OIF ciblent les métiers de la cybersécurité pour insérer la jeunesse** — wearetech.africa, 7 October 2026

> The Francophonie organisation and Djibouti's education and vocational training ministry signed an agreement to train 200 young people in web and mobile development and in network infrastructure and cybersecurity. It extends a programme that the organisation says has trained 200 since 2022.

Inclusion

Access to services

> WOMEN TRADERS PROGRAMME ON THE DJIBOUTI CORRIDOR

- **From export readiness to market access: EU-backed support strengthens women's participation in trade along the Djibouti-Ethiopia Corridor** — Horn Economic Review, 3 September 2026 ETHIOPIA

  40 women traders at Bishoftu, 30-31 Jul 2026, under the EUR 32m EU/AFD Djibouti Corridor programme; 94% unlicensed.

Data

Use of satellite data

> HYDROSAT NATIONAL SATELLITE PROGRAMME

- **Djibouti à la conquête de l'espace : un pari sur la science, la souveraineté et l'avenir** — La Nation, 10 September 2026

  State media traces Djibouti's space programme since its launch in 2020 as the head of state attends the first international space summit in Paris. It records the training of the country's first specialists and the design and orbiting of two nanosatellites among the steps taken.

- **Le Président Guelleh au Sommet international sur l'Espace : Djibouti défend une ambition spatiale au service du développement** — La Nation, 10 September 2026

  Djibouti's president took part in the second day of the first International Space Summit in Paris, arguing for a national space ambition serving development. The summit gathered delegations from more than 120 countries, including heads of state and government, institutional leaders, scientists, commercial operators and civil society.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

> DIGITAL AND MEDIA COOPERATION WITH THE UNITED STATES

- **Djibouti–États-Unis : un nouvel élan pour la coopération numérique et médiatique** — La Nation, 1 September 2026

  Minister Moussa Helem meets US Ambassador Kierscht on tech investment, media training.

China activities

> TALKS WITH HUAWEI ON DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Djibouti échange avec Huawei sur le développement de ses infrastructures numériques** — wearetech.africa, 17 September 2026

  Djibouti discussed the development of its digital infrastructure with Huawei, against its position on the telecommunications routes linking Africa, Asia and the Middle East and its stated ambition to become a regional digital hub. No agreement or project has been published.

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